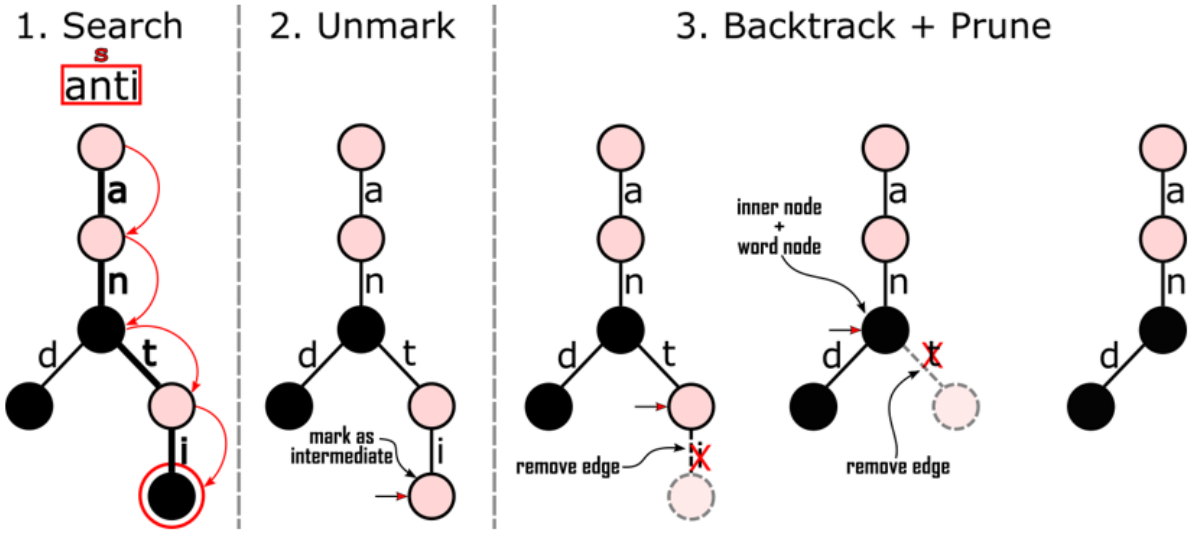


Figure 6.9 An example of method delete:
1. Find the key to delete;
2. Mark the node at the end of the path as "intermediate node";
3. Prune the tree to remove dangling branches.

The solution, in these cases, is implementing a pruning method that will remove dangling nodes while backtracking the path traversed during search; if we have the guarantee that the trie is "clean", meaning there were no dangling branches before removing current node, there are just two conditions for which we would stop pruning, while backtracking:

- We reach a *key node*: obviously we can't remove a node holding a key.
- We reach an inner intermediate node: if, after removing the last edge in the path being backtracked, current node becomes a leaf, it can be removed; otherwise, if this node has other children, then all its sub-branches will hold at least a key (because of our premise) and